MSD VD2 · LWC PROTOTYPE · TEAM REFERENCE

Skinning shipped components: the never list

Skin only through what Salesforce documents. It upgrades every org three times a year and promises nothing about a component's internals.

As of 26 Oct 2026
Source: rules-skinning.md
component-from-design · customisation-tiers.md

THE LADDER

Try each rung in order. Stop at the first one that reaches the property.

1. **Attribute or `variant`**
   `variant="label-stacked"`
2. **SLDS utility on the host**
   Placement and inherited type only
3. **`--dxp-*` hook**
   Site branding (Theme panel)
4. **`--slds-c-*` hook** PROTO
   Dev preview in SLDS 2
5. **Global `--slds-g-*` on the host** PROTO
   Assignment is for theming tools
6. **Property on a `sep-` class**
   `.sep-listing-chip { … }`
7. **Documented `::part()`**
   On the line; last resort

Proto levers stay in the prototype only. List every use in `_docs/handover-styling-register.md`.

NEVER

Reach inside a component `upgrade gate`

- × Private hooks `--slds-s-*` or `--_slds-*` `no-slds-private-var`
- × A selector naming an SLDS class, e.g. bare `.slds-page-header` `no-slds-class-overrides`
- × Descendant chains into a component's internal markup
- × Undocumented or "internal use" attributes to unlock a hook
- → Stop at the host: tag, reflected attribute, or `sep-` class

Hard-code values

- × Raw hex, px, rem or font values, except as a `var()` fallback `no-hardcoded-values-slds2`
- × A `--slds-g-*` reference with no fallback `no-slds-var-without-fallback`
- × `!important`. Ours are unlayered; they already win
- × `--lwc-*` tokens or SLDS 1 classes (`slds-page-header_record-home`)
- × A relative `url()`. It 404s in the built site

Put a skin in the wrong place

- → All instances: the tag, in `site/components/<tag>.css`
- → Opt-in variant: a `sep-` class in that component's file
- × Editing `site.css`. It is generated by `npm run css`
- × Component hooks at `:root` in `design-tokens.css`
- × Setting a `--slds-g-*` global outside `design-tokens.css`
- × Spacing baked into a `sep-` class. Placement stays a utility

Rebuild or fake it `custom-component gate`

- × Rebuild a shipped control (combobox, modal, tabs, pill, toggle) because the skin falls short
- × Build a new custom component without asking the user first
- × Script a class on to fake a state the shadow root owns (hover, filled)
- × Remove SLDS
- → Record the gap and say what is off

Hide the risks

- ! `--slds-c-*` hooks: dev preview, not for production
- ! Re-pointed globals: comment each use
- ! Legacy `--sds-c-*`: unsupported, ask first
- → Regenerate the register after any skin change

Call it done because it compiles

- × Assume a hook works. Three in this project compiled and did nothing
- → Read the computed value off the element, per state
- → No browser? Report the skin as unverified
- → Lint the block: no fallback, class-override or private findings

Misuse a blueprint `the 37 no component renders`

- × Hand-write a blueprint a `lightning-*` component already renders. Check `/design-system` → Blueprints
- × Override the blueprint's SLDS class. Add a `sep-` class beside it
- × Select an inner element by its SLDS class. Add `sep-page-header__title` beside `slds-page-header__title`
- × Add state or keyboard to a blueprint without treating it as Tier 4, or hand-roll one for a control that ships
- → Badges: always `slds-badge` blueprint markup, never `lightning-badge`
- × Use a class without grepping the shipped CSS. `slds-table_column` and `slds-setup-assistant__step` don't ship
- × Use `--slds-s-pageheader-*`. The page header has no public hooks: set real properties on `.sep-page-header`
- × Put a responsive `sep-` modifier alongside `slds-m-*`. The utility's `!important` wins
- ! Blueprints aren't auto-updated by SLDS. They're our code to maintain

REGENERATE THE REGISTER

`node .claude/skills/component-from-design/styling-register.mjs`

TWO GATES

Upgrade gate: documented parts only. Custom-component gate: the user decides. Passing one doesn't pass the other.

READ IN FULL

`rules-skinning.md` · `component-from-design/SKILL.md` · `_docs/customisation-tiers.md`